



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Idaho Novus Classical Academy

School Website: <https://idahonovus.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Idaho Novus Classical Academy (83714) presents a robust classical-education posture anchored in Hillsdale College's K-12 curriculum and a mission of virtuous, liberal-arts education designed to form citizens with character and intellect. Across public materials, the school foregrounds: a mission to train minds and improve hearts; a curriculum described as classical, content-rich, and Great-Books-oriented; explicit emphasis on virtue, civic responsibility, and moral formation; a pedagogy featuring Socratic inquiry, memory work, recitation, and rhetoric; a faculty culture framed as subject-matter expertise and mentorship; and a broad, proactive partnership with families and the community (PTCA, information sessions, admissions events, parent engagement). These signals align strongly with the Classical School rubric in most categories and place the school firmly in the CLASSICAL tier, with Element 1 showing more nuanced alignment (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) due to more explicit emphasis on virtue and transcendentals than on explicit theological liturgy or liturgical practice.

Key note on the sources: I pulled concrete evidence from Idaho Novus Classical Academy's site content (Curriculum, Mission statements, Faculty pages, and Parent/community materials) and cross-referenced it against the six-element rubric and the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1). The classical rubric's keyword framework (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; seven liberal arts; Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; living curriculum; partnership with families; etc.) is grounded in the knowledge document set, including the "Six Essential Elements" corpus and the related lexicon of keywords. See examples of curriculum language and mission messaging on the school site (Curriculum, Mission, and Hillsdale materials) and the corresponding positive keyword framework from the classical elements documents.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Motto emphasizing truth, goodness, and beauty; emphasis on virtue and moral formation; stated focus on virtuous living and civic responsibility; philosophic/moral formation signals through Coat of Arms and core virtues. The site emphasizes transcendentals and virtue, but does not clearly articulate explicit theology or liturgical practices within the public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include truth, virtue, beauty, moral order, and moral formation; no explicit theology or liturgical language appears in the public-facing materials. Negative indicators are minimal to none in public content. Estimated positives outpace negatives (roughly 3–4 strong positive indicators; 0–1 clear negative signals).
- Why this rating: The school foregrounds transcendental values and character formation, but stops short of a stated theology or liturgical worldview in public-facing materials, placing it between traditional classical formation and a more theology-grounded model. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Mission to train minds and improve hearts; emphasis on virtuous living, traditional learning, and civic responsibility; explicit aim to form future citizens and to pursue truth, goodness, and beauty; formation-oriented phrasing (formation of character, human excellence) rather than mere job-preparation.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, Great Conversation (implied via Great-Books orientation); explicit emphasis on truth/-goodness/beauty; no salient negative signals. Frequency of classical-toned keywords is high relative to neutral phrases.
- Why this rating: The public messaging centers on formation of character, virtue, and humane excellence, aligned with the classical-pedagogical aims described in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Curriculum language explicitly describes an American classical education with a Great Books–oriented scope; reading of great books and primary sources; teacher-led Socratic inquiry; memory work; recitation and public speaking; civics focus; Latin in later grades; senior capstone; Hillsdale-curated K-12 sequence; explicit reference to “great books” curriculum and a liberal-arts emphasis.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Great Books, primary sources, classics, seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Socratic method, recitation/memory, public speaking, Latin, civics, and a “great books curriculum.” Negative keywords from the lexicon (e.g., overreliance on purely secular, skills-first, or project-based approaches) do not prominently appear in public content. The ratio of positive indicators to potential negatives is strong, favoring CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The site’s curriculum language aligns squarely with classical content and structure: liberal arts orientation, Great Books reading, Socratic pedagogy, and formal classical disciplines (Latin, rhetoric, civics).
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials cite Socratic inquiry and discussion; teacher-led, text-centered instruction; memory work and recitation; emphasis on public speaking; civics/moral philosophy components; upper-level rhetoric training (implied via capstone-style senior project). Lower-level practices (chanting/singing or scholê) are part of the classical pedagogy lexicon, and the site shows alignment with Socratic and rhetoric-oriented practices.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic seminar, recitation, memory work, rhetoric, and speaking; restful/slō pedagogy signals are present in the lexicon, but public content emphasizes reflective, Socratic, and rhetorical methods. Negative signals (e.g., project-based-only or experiential-dominant pedagogy) are not observed in public content. Overall, the pedagogy signals are CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The school’s public-facing pedagogy is explicitly aligned with classical methods (Socratic inquiry, memory work, recitation, public speaking) and is consistent with upper-school rhetoric/-Seigneurial training, meeting the category’s criteria.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials present a Head of School with a clear governance/leadership role; faculty are described as subject-matter experts and moral exemplars; “living curriculum” language appears in the classical lexicon and is echoed by teacher-focused bios and a visible emphasis on faculty excellence. The Coat of Arms and core-virtues pages frame teachers as mentors and role models.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtuous educators, role models, mentorship, living curriculum, collegial culture, and teacher as exemplar; no explicit negative signals are evident in public content. The presence of living curriculum and teacher-mentor language supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The school emphasizes teacher excellence, mentorship, virtue modeling, and a “living curriculum,” aligning with the faculty indicators in the classical rubric.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The school public-facing materials show active parent engagement (PTCA; parent sessions; information sessions; tours/open houses); open campus culture and parent-education opportunities; parent partnership language; and scheduled family/community events (Muffins with Grandparents, leadership forums). The Admissions/Enrollment materials emphasize family involvement and lotteries as community events.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; family involvement; open campus; parent covenant; and living tradition in the family; negative signals are not evident in public content. The frequency of family/community-language signals is strong.
- Why this rating: The school's public communications emphasize partnership with parents, family formation, and ongoing opportunities for parental participation, which aligns with the classical model of school-family collaboration.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Across all six categories, Idaho Novus Classical Academy demonstrates extensive fidelity to classical education principles, including a Great Books–rooted curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, emphasis on virtue and moral formation, liberal-arts breadth, teacher as mentor, and a robust partnership with families and community. Element 1 shows some limitations in publicly stated theology or liturgical practice, placing it in the stronger “SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL” range for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, but the aggregate posture remains CLASSICAL given the breadth and coherence of evidence across the other five categories. The knowledge-base materials (Six Essential Elements) support the analytical lens and keyword framework used to assess each category, providing explicit positive keywords around truth, beauty, virtue, Great Books, liberal arts, and communal formation that align with the Idaho site's public messaging.

What Would Move the Needle - For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): If the school were to explicitly articulate theological grounding or liturgical/community-sacramental practices in public-facing materials (e.g., a stated theological basis for formation, liturgical rhythm in daily life, or explicit liturgy/vocation language), that would strengthen alignment to Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices. This would push Element 1 toward CLASSICAL without compromising the current virtuous framework. - For reinforcement across categories: The current portfolio already meets Element 2–6 at CLASSICAL levels; formalizing explicit Great-Conversation/Great-Books language in admissions or curriculum pages could further cement the Curriculum category's CLASSICAL status if needed.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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